RIO + 20-UNITED NATIONS CONFERENCE ON SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT, 13–22 JUNE 2012

The United Nations Conference on Environment and Development (UNCED and also referred to as the Rio Summit or the Earth Summit) was held during
3–14 June 1992. The chief achievement of this Summit was the *Agenda 21: Green Paths to the Future* or the *Rio Declaration of 1992.* The Rio Declaration consisted of 27 principles intended to guide future sustainable development around the world. Some of the principles contained in the Rio Declaration may be regarded as third generation rights. [See Chapter 14, pages 328–332]

Rio + 20 was a 20-year follow-up to the 1992 Rio Earth Summit/United Nations Conference on Environment and Development (UNCED) and the 10th anniversary of the 2002 World Summit on Sustainable Development (WSSD) in Johannesburg. It was hosted by Brazil in Rio de Janeiro from 13–22 June 2012.

Rio + 20 Summit was focussed on two themes: A green economy in the context of sustainable development and poverty eradication and the institutional framework for sustainable development. The Conference focused on critical issues like jobs, energy, cities, food, water, oceans and disasters and preparedness to tackle them.

The outcome document of Rio + 20 is *The Future We Want By, For and With All Stakeholders Redefining the Multi-Stakeholder Partnership Contract*. The Future We Want emphasizes the process to establish sustainable development goals; detailing how the green economy can be used as a tool to achieve sustainable development; strengthening the UN Environment Programme (UNEP); promoting corporate sustainability reporting measures; taking steps to go beyond gross domestic product to assess the well-being of a country; developing a strategy for sustainable development financing; and, adopting a framework for tackling sustainable consumption and production. Alongside, the document underscores the importance of establishing gender equity; recognized the importance of voluntary commitments on sustainable development; and stressed the need to engage civil society and incorporate